

Reasoning Reference: Blood Relations

Educational Series

December 29, 2025

1 Introduction

Blood Relation problems test your ability to identify relationships among various family members. The most effective way to solve these is by drawing a **Family Tree** using standard symbols and representing different generations on separate levels.

2 Standard Family Tree Symbols

Using consistent symbols helps avoid confusion between gender and relationship types:

- **Square or (+):** Represents a Male member.
- **Circle or (-):** Represents a Female member.
- **Double Horizontal Lines (=):** Represents a Married Couple.
- **Single Horizontal Line (-):** Represents Siblings (Brother/Sister).
- **Vertical Line (|):** Represents the link between parents and children (Difference in generation).

3 Generation Levels

Organize the tree vertically based on age/hierarchy:

1. **Generation 1:** Grandparents (Paternal/Maternal).
2. **Generation 2:** Parents, Uncles, Aunts, Father-in-law, Mother-in-law.
3. **Generation 3:** Self, Siblings, Cousins, Spouse, Brother-in-law, Sister-in-law.
4. **Generation 4:** Children, Niece, Nephew, Son-in-law, Daughter-in-law.

4 Important Relationship Terms

5 Solving Strategy

- **Identify Gender:** Never assume gender based on a name unless specified (e.g., "A is the father of B").
- **Draw the Tree:** Start from the person being pointed to or the person speaking.
- **Break the Sentence:** In "Pointing to a photograph" problems, break the description from the end (e.g., "only son of my father's father").

Description	Relationship Name
Father's or Mother's Father	Grandfather
Father's or Mother's Brother	Uncle
Father's or Mother's Sister	Aunt
Son's Wife	Daughter-in-law
Daughter's Husband	Son-in-law
Husband's or Wife's Brother	Brother-in-law
Husband's or Wife's Sister	Sister-in-law
Brother's or Sister's Son	Nephew
Brother's or Sister's Daughter	Niece
Uncle's or Aunt's Child	Cousin

6 Solved Example

Problem: Pointing to a photograph, a man said, "I have no brother or sister but that man's father is my father's son." Whose photograph was it?

Solution:

1. Analyze "my father's son": Since the speaker has no brother or sister, *his father's son* is **himself**.
2. Substitute back into the sentence: "That man's father is **me**."
3. Conclusion: If the man in the photo has the speaker as his father, the man in the photo is the **Speaker's Son**.